

External Writers
Yamaha CRW 2200IX-VK
(20/10/40) FireWire

This is the only 20x FireWire writer available in the market. The FireWire writers generally have a slower transfer rate than USB 2.0 writers, but the Yamaha FireWire impressed us with faster scores than the USB 2.0 writer we tested. It took 302 seconds (5 minutes 2 seconds) to burn the ISO image on CD-R and 257 seconds (4 minutes 17 seconds) to burn the audio CD. This makes it at least 10-15 per cent faster than its USB 2.0 counterpart. The writer was also fast in reading the data and logged a read speed of 29x. The Yamaha FireWire comes with



Yamaha's fiery FireWire writer

an 8 MB buffer, which makes it Burn-Proof in the true sense. The writer weighed 1.58 kg, which puts it on the lighter side of the external writers. The only problem a PC user could face is in terms of FireWire support as most PCs lack this. The writer is on the costlier side and comes at a hefty price tag of Rs 24,000 (the FireWire card and cables cost approximately Rs 6,000 extra).

SPECIFICATIONS
20/10/40x speed, 8 MB buffer, FireWire interface

Acer CRW 4406EU (USB)

This is probably the cheapest external writer one can get. It has a USB 1.1 interface which makes it inexpensive but slow. The writer took 1,275 seconds (21 minutes 15 seconds) to burn the ISO image at 4X on CD-R and 1,045 seconds (17 minutes 25 seconds) to burn the audio CD. To burn the assorted data on the CD-RW, it took 1,180 seconds (19 minutes 40 seconds) which was less than the time taken to write the same data on a CD-R (1,189 seconds; or 19 minutes 49 seconds). This Acer writer had a regular 2 MB buffer and was equipped with Seamless Link burn proof technology.

It came bundled with Easy CD Creator 4.02 and DirectCD 3.0 burning software. Priced at Rs 8,999, it is



Less of a speed demon, more of value

the cheapest CD-Writer in the market. However, given its slow speed, it's not suited for continuous writing work where lots of data needs to be burned in a short time. However, it will suit the needs of a home user who has run out of a free IDE connection and doesn't want to spend much on the writer.

SPECIFICATIONS
4/4/6x speed, 2 MB buffer, Seamless Link burn proof technology.

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